GENERAL ACADEMIC TUTORING



Living in Germany

THWS International Students' Tutor
Ertugrul Kiyici

TODAY'S TOPICS



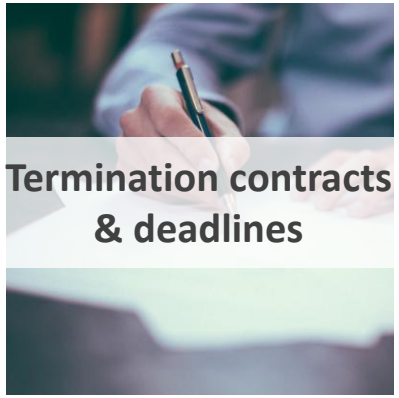
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Information about Germany



Important regulations



Termination contracts & deadlines



Shopping



German Culture
Frühjahrsvolksfest



Waste Disposal & Deposit (Pfand)



Renting aspects

INFORMATION ABOUT GERMANY



Germany (officially the Federal Republic of Germany) is the **second most populous** and **seventh-largest country in Europe**; bordering **Denmark** to the north, **Poland** and the **Czech Republic** to the east, **Austria** to the southeast, and **Switzerland** to the south-southwest. **France, Luxembourg** and **Belgium** are situated to the west, with the **Netherlands** to the northwest.



INFORMATION ABOUT GERMANY



Capital and largest city	**Berlin** **52°31’N 13°23’E**
Official language	**German**
Population **(estimated)**	**84,075,075 (2025)**
Government	**Federal parliamentary republic**
• **President**	**Frank-Walter Steinmeier**
• **Chancellor**	**Olaf Scholz**







INFORMATION ABOUT GERMANY

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- **You're interested in education, health, culture, history, the media, politics, sport, tourism, the economy or system of government?**

- You can find comprehensive information and links on all these topics in many different languages at the Internet portal **www.deutschland.de**, in the online edition of "***Deutschland Magazine***" as well as in the online edition of **Facts About Germany**.

- https://www.deutschland.de/en
- https://www.tatsachen-ueber-deutschland.de/en
- https://www.auswaertiges-amt.de/en
- https://www.dw.com/en/top-stories/s-9097
- https://learngerman.dw.com/en/learn-german/s-9528





INFORMATION ABOUT GERMANY



https://www.timeanddate.com/calendar/print.html?year=2023&country=8&cols=3&df=1

https://fiw.thws.de/en/studies/planning-your-studies/dates-and-deadlines/

https://www.thws.de/en/services-and-support/application-enrolment-exams-internship/

Holidays and Observances:

1 Jan	New Year's Day	10 Apr	Easter Monday	31 Oct	Reformation Day (Most regions)
6 Jan	Epiphany (BW, BY, ST)	1 May	May Day	31 Oct	Halloween
14 Feb	Valentine's Day	8 May	End of World War II (Many regions)	1 Nov	All Saints' Day (Many regions)
20 Feb	Shrove Monday	14 May	Mothers' Day	11 Nov	St. Martin's Day
21 Feb	Carnival Tuesday	18 May	Fathers' Day	19 Nov	National Day of Mourning
22 Feb	Carnival / Ash Wednesday	18 May	Ascension Day	22 Nov	Repentance Day (Saxony)
8 Mar	International Women's Day (Most regions)	28 May	Whit Sunday (Brandenburg)	26 Nov	Sunday of the Dead
8 Mar	International Women's Day (Berlin, Mecklenburg-Western Pomerania)	28 May	Whit Sunday (Most regions)	3 Dec	First Advent Sunday
2 Apr	Palm Sunday	29 May	Whit Monday	6 Dec	Saint Nicholas Day
6 Apr	Maundy Thursday (All)	8 Jun	Corpus Christi (Many regions)	10 Dec	Second Advent Sunday
7 Apr	Good Friday	15 Aug	Assumption of Mary (Saxony, Thuringia)	17 Dec	Third Advent Sunday
8 Apr	Holy Saturday (Many regions)	15 Aug	Assumption of Mary (Bavaria, Saarland)	24 Dec	Fourth Advent Sunday
9 Apr	Easter Sunday (Most regions)	20 Sep	German World Children's Day (Thuringia)	25 Dec	Christmas Day
9 Apr	Easter Sunday (Brandenburg)	3 Oct	Day of German Unity	26 Dec	Boxing Day

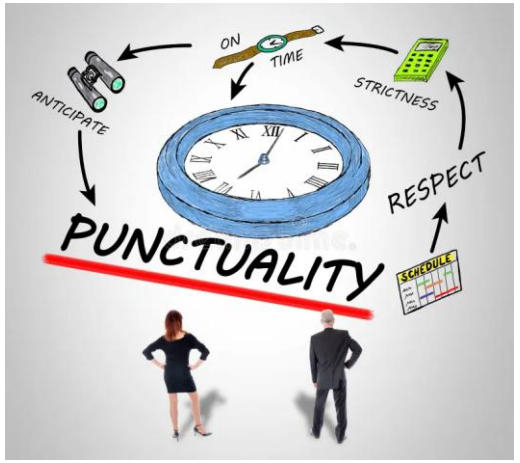
Calendar generated on www.timeanddate.com/calendar

GERMAN CULTURE

- German culture and people are, to a large extent, all about **reason** and **logic**.
- Germany shares a lot of culture and tradition with neighbouring countries, especially the Germanic-speaking **Austria** and **Switzerland**.
- An important thing to know about German culture is that residents are expected **to respect order and structure.** It's important **to be on time, not just for work but for social events too**, and to **follow rules** that are in place for the greater good of everybody who lives there.









GERMAN CULTURE

- German culture is **low context** = **say what you mean directly.**

3 High Context vs. Low Context Cultures

High Context / Indirect	Low Context / Direct
High Context: The spoken word is not the primary means of communication. Key: nonverbal hints and context.	**Low Context:** The message is explicit and spelled out. Words are the primary means of communication.
Indirect: You need to read between the lines. Tendency to infer, suggest and imply. Words should not be interpreted literally. Implicit messages.	**Direct:** People say what they mean and mean what they say. The truth is more important than other‘s feelings. What isn‘t said isn‘t communicated.
Face is key: Maintaining harmony and saving face is the overriding goal of communication: confrontation is avoided. Saying ‚no‘ is difficult	**Face less important:** Getting and giving information is the overriding goal of communication. It is OK to criticize or to say ‚no‘ rather than run the risk of misunderstanding.

GERMAN CULTURE

- Germany is home to over 84 million people – as well as a diverse array of religions, customs, and traditions that make up the rich national culture.
- Germany is known for its long and rich history, one that has put it at the forefront of European thought, politics, and art for over 1,000 years.
- **Good beer** (and *Oktoberfest*), **delicious sausages**, **hiking**, traditional 'Oom-Pah' **folk music**, and **holiday-making** make-up a key part of the country's identity.

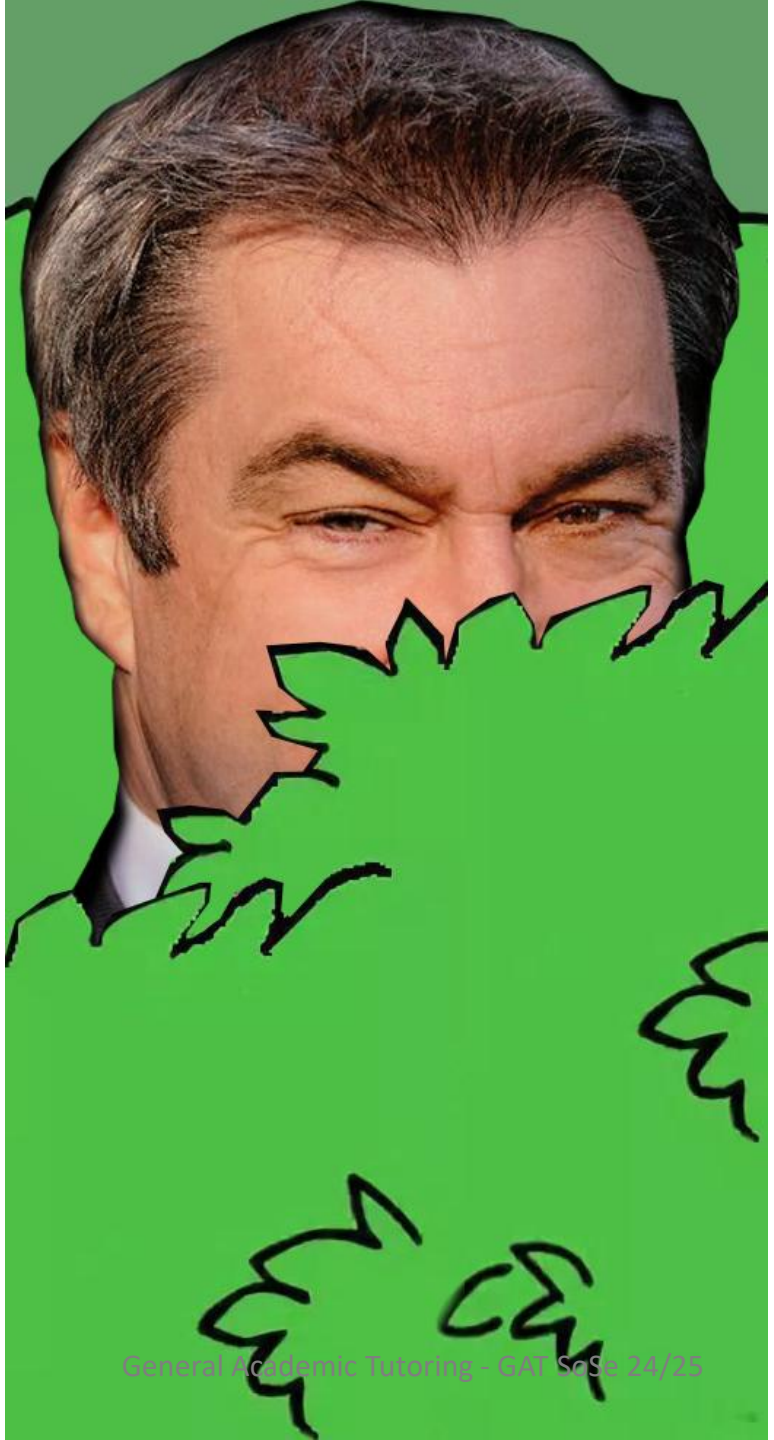






CULTURE
Welcome, Servus and Grüß Gott

- Bavaria: a federal state of Germany
- The state capital of Bavaria is **Munich**
- Bavaria is the largest German state, area is more than 70,500 km^2
- Around **13 million people** live here, of whom around 3 million have a migration background
- **Bavaria has its own state government.** Bavaria is able to act independently and issue its own laws
- The head of the Bavarian government is called the Minister President. The current one is **Dr. Markus Söder**
- In addition to all his achievements for the region, there is a whole **meme culture** around him



- Many people in Bavaria **speak a dialect**
- Bavaria is a **hospitable** and **traditional** federal state
- The Bavarian **economy** ranks amongst the best in the world
- There are diverse range of **regional cuisines** and enduring **traditions and customs**
- There is no state religion. **Freedom of religion is a basic right**
- Around two thirds of the Bavarian population **are Christian**.
- **Christian values** are part of the **Bavarian identity** and characterise the moral values and traditions followed here
- Many of the **public holidays** have a **religious background**.
- The churches in Bavaria also play an **important role** in assisting refugees and integrating people with a migrant background.

CULTURE, Typically Bavarian

Traditions and customs are hugely important in Bavaria and are an inherent part of Bavarian culture. Customs differ depending on the region.

- **MUNICH OKTOBERFEST (21.09 – 04.10)**

The Munich Oktoberfest is the largest public festival in the world. The breweries in Munich even brew a special beer for the Oktoberfest.

- **NUREMBERG CHRISTKINDLESMARKT (01.12 - 27.12)**

The Nuremberg Christkindlesmarkt is one of the oldest Christmas markets in Germany. It has been held since the 16th century. It is one of the largest Christmas markets in Germany.

- **TRADITIONAL CLOTHING (TRACHTEN)**

Traditional costumes "Tracht": **"Dirndl"** for the girls and **"Lederhosen"** for the boys

→ You wear it during Octoberfest in Munich or even during other Bavarian carnivals (not obligatory).

- **COUNTRYSIDE AND NATURE**

Bavaria is also known as the land of lakes and mountains. The Bavarian Alps, Bavarian Forest and the Fichtel Mountains attract millions of skiers and hikers to the mountains every year.

- **BEER & THE BAVARIAN PURITY LAW**

Bavarian beer is popular around the world. There are more than 600 breweries in Bavaria that brew their beer according to the **Bavarian purity law from 1516**. The only ingredients allowed are hops, barley and water.

- **BEER GARDENS**

These outdoor gastronomic facilities are part of Bavarian culture.

- **PALACES, CHURCHES, CASTLES AND GARDENS**

Bavaria has a large number of historical sights such as Castle **Neuschwanstein**, **Passau Cathedral** and **Walhalla** near Regensburg.

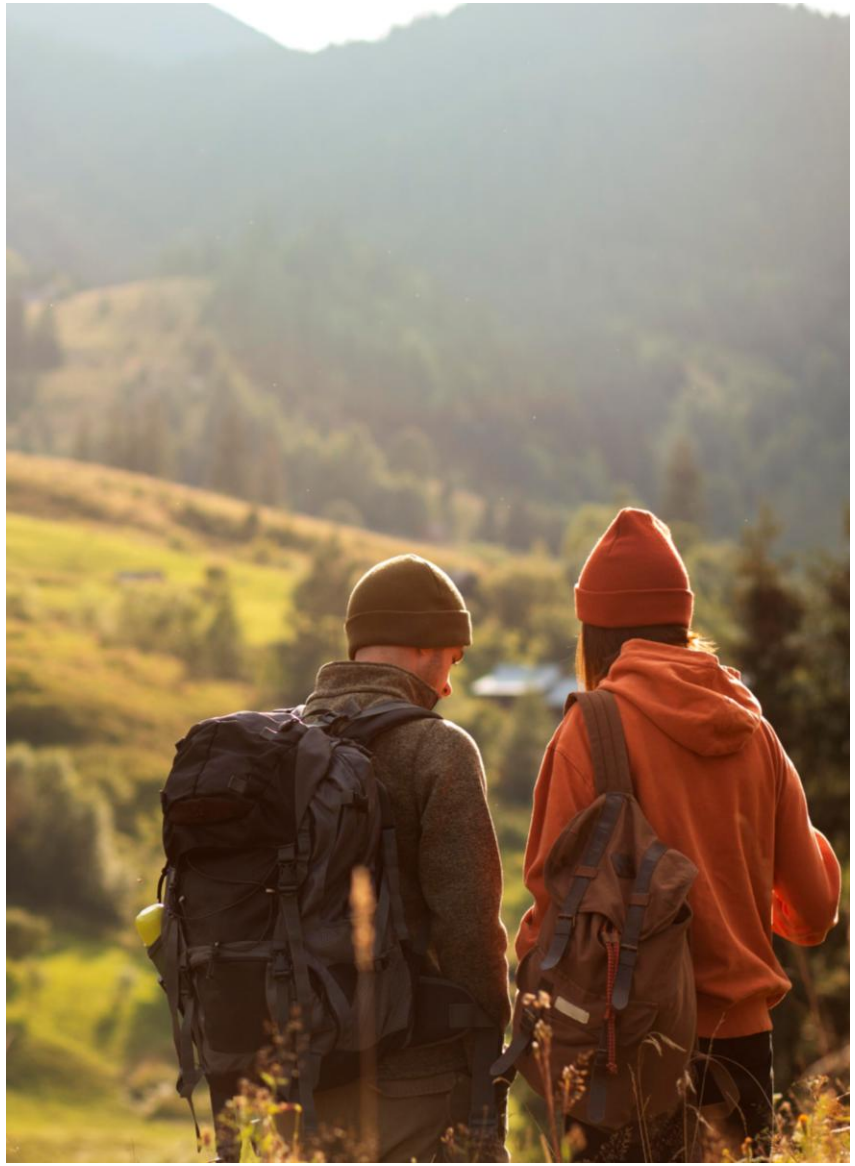


*More information is available here

CULTURE
Bavarian & Franconian Culture

- Some of the characteristic **gastronomic traditions**:
  - ✓ Bavarian **Pretzels** – delicious salty pastry
  - ✓ "**Weißwurst**" and "**Nürnberger Bratwurs**" – traditional Bavarian sausages
  - ✓ "**Schweinshaxn mit Kloß**" – pork leg with Bavarian dumplings

- **Wine-growing**. Franconia is a very famous wine-growing region. Franconian wine is known for the special bulbous shape of the bottles – the so-called "**Bocksbeutel**".
- **Wandern** is real culture for the Germans. Wandern (Hiking) is a long, vigorous walk, usually on trails or footpaths in the countryside. Walking for pleasure developed in Europe during the 18th century.
- In Germany there is overwhelming popularity of **barbecues**. Germans take their barbecues seriously. There are a plenty of "**Grillkurse**" to learn a lot of grilling technique. The answer to the question of **whether or not you may legally barbecue on your balcony** is contained in your rental agreement. If your contract states that barbecuing is not allowed on the premises, then sorry: your grilling fun is restricted to **designated public spaces**.
- **Sports culture:**
  Football: FC Bayern München, 1.FC Nürnberg "Der Glubb"
  Ice Hockey: EHC Red Bull München, Ice Tigers Nürnberg
  Basketball: s.Oliver Würzburg, Brose Bamberg



IMPORTANT REGULATIONS

If everyone in the community **follows the rules** and **does things the right way,** the neighbourhood/town/city/country will be **a nice place for all residents to live.**

The Basic Law or **"Grundgesetz"** is the **constitution** of the **Federal Republic of Germany**.

It includes the most fundamental rights that determine the way society is organised in Germany.

https://handbookgermany.de/en/basic-law



IMPORTANT REGULATIONS



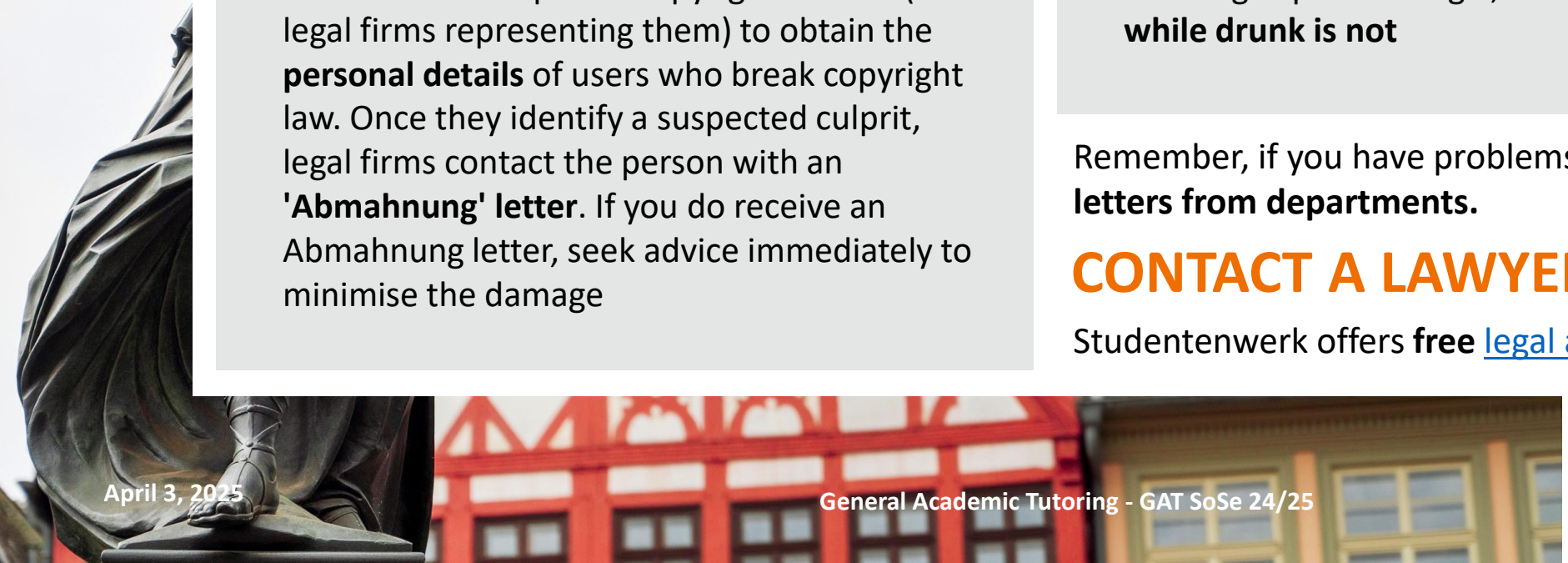
- It‘s mandatory to have **some form of ID** on you at all times
- Pedestrians who **cross a road** while the pedestrian traffic light is **red** can be subjected to fines (if spotted by the police)
- **Downloading, sharing, or streaming copyrighted content** in Germany illegally. Penalties for breaking copyright law can include significant fines and even prison sentences. German laws empower copyright holders (and legal firms representing them) to obtain the **personal details** of users who break copyright law. Once they identify a suspected culprit, legal firms contact the person with an **'Abmahnung' letter**. If you do receive an Abmahnung letter, seek advice immediately to minimise the damage

- 'Ruhezeiten' (quiet periods / no loud noises). You should check whether the house you are living in has defined **quiet periods** during the day as part of the house rules. These should be observed in addition to the general quiet periods. **The near-universal quiet periods are**: From 10pm to 6am (or 7am in some areas). All day on Sundays and public holidays
- **Possession of cannabis in Bavaria is illegal** and a felony over 6 grams. **Cannabis possession under 6 grams can still cost you your residence permit**
- Drinking in public is legal, however **riding a bike or a scooter while drunk is not**

Remember, if you have problems with the law, **do not ignore letters from departments.**

CONTACT A LAWYER FOR HELP

Studentenwerk offers **free** legal advice for students.



IMPORTANT REGULATIONS

German Civil Code (Bürgerliches Gesetzbuch (BGB))

- The Civil Code (BGB) regulates private matters such as family law and purchase, lease and service contracts

The German Social Code (Sozialgesetzbuch (SGB))

- Basic protection for jobseekers, statutory health insurance, housing and child benefit.

Migration law, residence law, asylum law

- Citizens from EU states are covered by different residence legislation than migrants from third countries and asylum seekers.

Highway code (Straßenverkehrsordnung (StVO))

Criminal code (Strafgesetzbuch (StGB))





IMPORTANT REGULATIONS

It‘s mandatory to have some form of ID (e.g.: passport or residence permit) with you at all times. **Not as a photo, a real physical ID !**

Drinking in public is legal (except in case of between 22.00-06.00 in some neighbourhood) however riding a bike or a scooter or any type of vehicle that you can use in public road while drunk is not allowed and high penalties (up to 2000-€) or jurisdiction is possible.

https://www.uni-passau.de/en/housing/german-laws-everyday-life/







TERMINATON OF CONTRACTS & DEADLINES

- Make sure you have **thoroughly read** your contract
- Most contracts are for 24 months (mentionef below.)
- As of 2022, **tacit renewals** of contracts **are no longer permitted** unless the contract is for an unlimited period
- As of 2022, the customer has the right to terminate the contract at any time **with one month's notice**, and a more extended notice period cannot be set
- Cancel your contract **in time**! (Keep a reminder)
- Contracts **you have to cancel** when moving:

- ✓ rental contract;
- ✓ electricity, gas, water;
- ✓ phone & internet contract;
- ✓ bank contract;
- ✓ insurance contract;
- ✓ employment contract;
- ✓ GEZ contract;
- ✓ gym memberships;
- ✓ newspaper and magazine subscriptions

*More information is available here



SHOPPING
General information

- **Opening hours:**

✓ Grocery shops : Mo-Sa 7-20
✓ Clothes : Mo-Fr 10-18, Sa 10-16
✓ Electronics : Mo-Sa 10-20
✓ Gas Stations : Mo-Sa 6-22 (some of them are open on Sunday & holidays too!)

- Normally, shops **are closed on Sunday!**

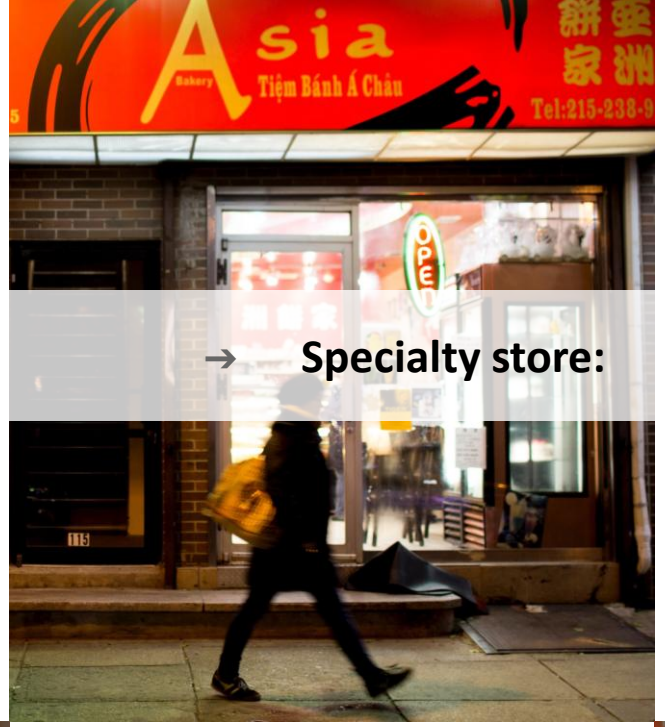
- **Weekly offers change** (esp. Grocery) → COMPARE! (Mein Prospekt App / marktguru / Shop brochures)

- Payment in Cash or Bank card (mostly **no credit cards**)



SHOPPING

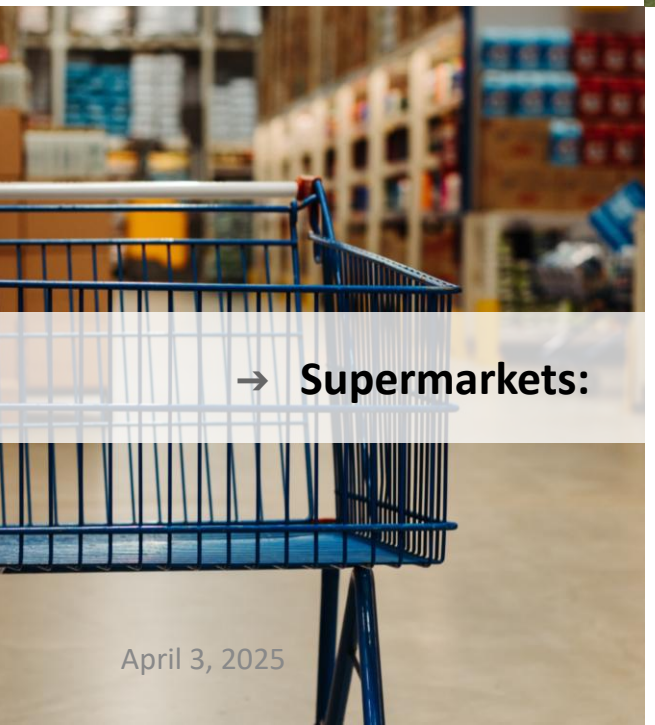
International grocery shopping in Würzburg



→ **Specialty store:**

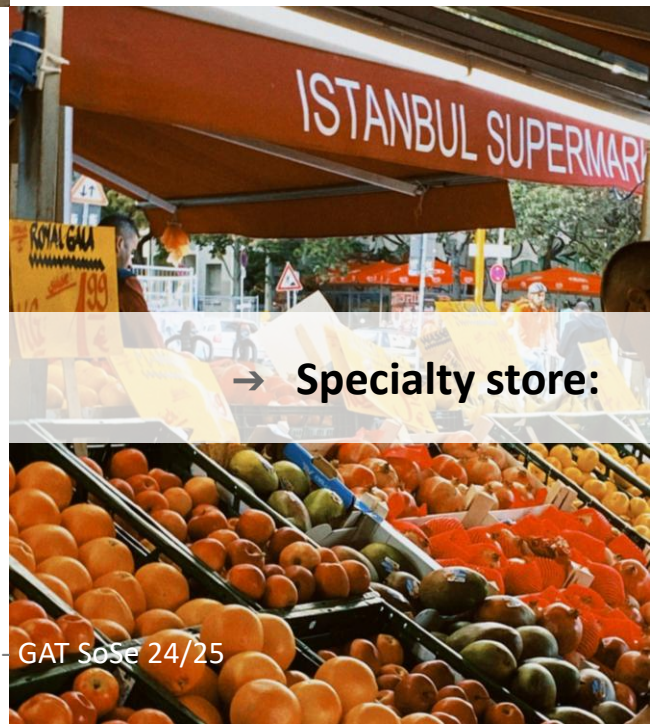
South/East Asian:
Asia Shop Thanh Tin, Nürnberger Str. 76
go asia Supermarkt, Kaiserstraße 14
TGB - The Grocery Brothers, Faulenbergstraße 9
Asia Market Bamboo, Semmelstraße 36

Indian:
TGB - The Grocery Brothers, Faulenbergstraße 9
Indian Store, Oberthürstraße 2-6
go asia Supermarkt, Kaiserstraße 14



→ **Supermarkets:**

Kaufland:
Nürnberger Str. 12 Industriestraße 3-5
Edeka:
Nürnberger Str. 61
Domstraße 10
Brettreichstraße 2
and many other
Rewe:
Rottendorfer Str. 67 Frankfurter Str. 56



→ **Specialty store:**

Eastern Europe:
Mix Markt, Heisenbergstraße 4A
Astana, Place de Caen 6

Turkish:
AHSA EINKAUFSZENTRUM, Nürnberger Str. 14
Al Saadeh, Bahnhofstraße 3

Syrian:
Jasmin, Semmelstraße 26
Al Saadeh, Bahnhofstraße 3
Supermarkt Hayat, Bohnesmühlgasse 17

SHOPPING Clothes, furniture etc. in Würzburg





→ **Cloth:**



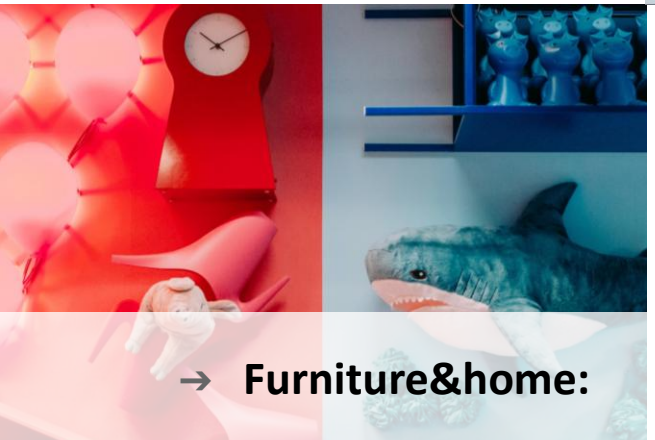
Eichhornstrasse:
The shopping mile in Würzburg.

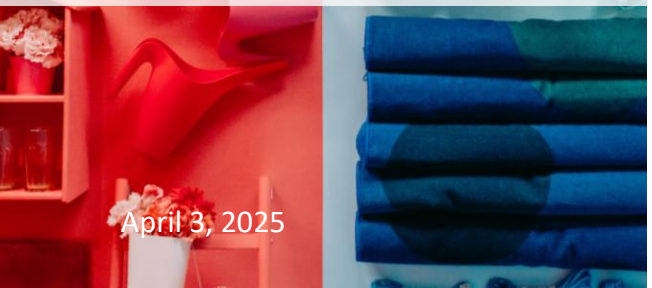
Kaiserstrasse:
Is a commercial street between the Würzburg train station forecourt and the Juliuspromenade.

H&M
Schönbornstraße 8

TKmaxx
Marktpl. 38

*Further information is available in German here





→ **Furniture&home:**

TKmaxx
Marktpl. 38
Ikea
Mainfrankenhöhe 2
JYSK
Mainfrankenhöhe 8
mömax
Wiesenweg 12
XXXLutz Neubert
Mergentheimer Str. 59





→ **Appliances:**

MediaMarkt:
Am Handelshof 2
Domstraße 5

comacs:
Herzogenstraße 3

Also in the supermarkets: **Aldi, Lidl, Kaufland**

Kleinanzeigen

GROCERY SHOPPING IN SCHWEIN FURT

Technical University of Applied Sciences Würzburg-Schweinfurt

Kaufland, Hauptbahnhofstraße 4
Edeka, Oskar-von-Miller-Straße 6

Indian:	VM Indian Bulgarian Store, Friedenstraße 20
South/East Asian:	Asia Shop Schweinfurt, Cramerstraße 5 LoanPhuc Asia Center, Seestraße 11 Mr. To Asiatische Lebensmittel, Graben 24
Syrian:	Supermarkt Damaskus, Wolfsgasse 13 Supermarkt Jasmin, Roßmarkt 3
Turkish:	Ariana Markt, Luitpoldstraße 23 Bilal Supermarkt, Luitpoldstraße 12 Eylül Supermarkt & Großhandel, Oskar-von-Miller-Straße 68 Intermarkt, Luitpoldstraße 13 Paradies Markt, Schopperstraße 1

CLOTHES SHOPPING

- Spring in Germany are usually cold and rainy. You can buy jackets and raincoats at these stores:

Rotkreuzladen (Red Cross secondhand store)

- City Center, Gabelsbergerstraße 2
- Market Square, Obere Str. 2
- Bergl, Berliner Pl. 12

Affordable: KIK

- City Center, Brückenstraße 1 – 3
- Bergl, Oskar-von-Miller-Straße 6

Mid-priced: H&M, Georg-Wichtermann-Platz 16

Numerous boutiques at the city mall: Stadtgalerie Schweinfurt

STADTGALERIE - SCHWEINFURT‘S MALL

Located at Schrammstraße 5

https://www.stadtgalerie-schweinfurt.de/

Includes numerous restaurants and stores for electronics, clothing, shoes, etc.



PLACES TO EAT / ORDER FOOD IN SW

Order Food: Liferando

Recommendations of Restaurants:

Breakfast/Brunch: Soul & Bowl, kleine kaffeerösterei

Asian: Ahn Tuan, Kai Sushi, Mekong Express

Italian: Aposto Schweinfurt

American: Jacknife



WASTE DISPOSAL

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RESIDUAL WASTE
Sweepings, heavily soiled packaging, cigarettes, used nappies, rags, leather residues, broken glass or animal litter, paper towels, tissues, saw dust, ash, wires, rubber.
Container color is **BLACK** 🖤

ORGANIC /BIO WASTE
Garden waste, eggshells, bones and leftovers (also cooked), coffee grounds and tea bags, fruit and vegetable waste, potato peelings, kitchen roll paper, fruit scraps and nutshells, feathers and hair, leftover bread and bakery products.
Container color is **BROWN** 🤎

PLASTIC WASTE
Aluminium foils, plastic wraps, cans, packaging materials, yoghurt cups, soaps/shampoo bottles, milk/ juice cartons, foil, tubes, crown caps, liquid detergent bottles
Container/container lid color is **YELLOW** 💛 or yellow bag

PAPER WASTE
Envelopes, letters, books, Catalogues, writing pads, school books, washing detergent cartons without plastic, paper boxes, newspapers
Container color is **BLUE** 💙

GLASS WASTE
All kinds of glass bottles, jars (without caps/stoppers)
Container colors matches the color of the glass of the bottle: **WHITE** (transparent) 🤍, **GREEN** 💚, **BROWN**

LIGHT BULBS/BATTERIES
Recycling bins at the entrance in your nearest electronics store, such as MediaMarkt, hardware stores such as Bauhaus and Hornbach, and supermarkets such as REWE, Aldi, or dm.





*More detailed information is available here

PFAND
Bottle deposit system



- Do not throw away deposit bottles!
- Pfand is a **portion of the price** on a bottled drink that **you can get back** if you return said bottle to a certified outlet
- **Einwegflaschen:** for recyclable but **non-reusable thin plastic bottles** and aluminum cans (0.25€ / bottle)
- **Mehrwegsflaschen:** for **glass or heavy-duty plastic bottles** (beer bottles) that can be refilled and are sold in cases or single (0.15€ / bottle)

- **Identification label:**





- **Pfandrückgabestelle:** Station where you deposit „Pfand“ back by simply returning the bottles to the machine. Found at most supermarkets either at the entrance or at the section where drinks are sold
- **Wine and spirits bottles are not accepted**, since there are a wide variety of shapes and sizes. → glass recycling
- **Water, beer and softdrink bottles** are standardized bottle shapes and are accepted

*More information is available here

RENTING ASPECTS

- **Air Circulation:** At least 2-3 times per day with open window (heaters off!)
- **Waste:** Separate: paper (blue) – plastic (yellow) – glas (containers) – residual (black) – bio (brown)
- **Parties:** Inform your neighbours, keep the volume low
- **Cleaning:** Clean regularly! Washing machines in basement or self-service laundry in the city
- **Repairing:** Inform the housekeeper, landlord

Typically, you are allowed to alter most things in rental flats: from the **colour of the walls** to the **shelves hanging** on them. However, you're expected to put **everything back in its original state** when you move out. So, upon moving out, the landlord will - unless otherwise agreed - have the flat with white walls and thoroughly cleaned. **Most rental agreements state this beforehand.**





NEXT WEEK‘S TOPICS

1. Transportation in Germany
2. Travel Destinations (in Germany & Europe)
3. Accommodation Options (for travelling)
4. Schengen Area
5. International Student Club (ISC) Events & Trips
6. Questions

TIME FOR QUESTIONS!



ertugrul.kiyici@study.thws.de


THANK YOU